

Modern
J-class
racing
yacht

BERMUDA RIG

The layout of the sail and mast is called the rig. The Bermuda rig was invented in the 17th century to help small boats wind through the tricky waters around Bermuda in the Atlantic Ocean. This rig has just two triangular sails hung from a single mast. There is a small “headsail” at the front and a large “mainsail” on a swinging arm, or boom, behind. Modern racing yachts use the Bermuda rig as it makes the boat fast and easy to maneuver.

GET MOVING



AUTOMATIC SAILS

In the 1960s, the German engineer Wilhelm Pröls designed a rig called the Dyna-Rig. In this arrangement, tall masts carry sails that are moved by motors, so a giant sailing ship can be sailed by just one person. The Maltese Falcon (above), the first Dyna-Rig yacht, is one of the world's largest yachts.

Sails have adjustable flaps, like airplane wings, to reduce wind drag.

